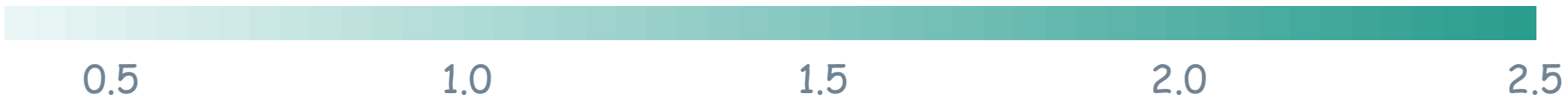


03 REGIONAL OPPORTUNITIES DIFFER

China and 11 RCEP partner markets

Allocated export proxy / model-implied exports

	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022
Japan	0.65	0.64	0.54	0.55	0.59	0.57	0.57	0.52	0.47	0.69
New Zealand	0.52	0.57	0.58	0.65	0.62	0.61	0.63	0.61	0.58	0.83
Laos	0.61	1.12	0.81	1.67	0.59	0.41	0.51	0.40	0.36	0.59
South Korea	0.77	0.82	0.72	0.76	0.79	0.74	0.81	0.74	0.69	1.05
Australia	0.77	0.86	0.82	0.98	1.01	1.02	1.08	1.13	0.96	1.32
Singapore	1.05	1.05	0.98	0.94	0.91	0.86	0.97	0.97	0.61	1.03
Malaysia	1.24	1.05	0.96	0.98	1.06	0.99	1.13	1.15	1.12	1.47
Indonesia	1.12	1.33	1.06	1.10	1.07	1.14	1.18	1.00	1.05	1.33
Vietnam	1.27	1.64	1.48	1.54	1.59	1.48	1.65	1.68	1.50	1.74
Thailand	1.33	1.58	1.57	1.77	1.64	1.51	1.54	1.64	1.72	2.45
Philippines	1.23	1.52	1.47	1.92	1.96	1.84	2.00	1.86	1.80	2.24



Categories use 2013–2022 country averages:

Below 0.8

More unused potential

0.8–1.2

Scope to develop

Above 1.2

New approaches needed

Read the model before the colour

Each ratio compares an allocated export proxy with model-implied exports. A lower value means less proxy trade relative to the benchmark, not necessarily a smaller market. Japan and New Zealand average 0.580 and 0.619; Thailand and the Philippines average 1.676 and 1.783. Below 0.8, the authors identify unused potential; above 1.2, they suggest innovative trade models or new trade areas.

Average and latest year differ

New Zealand's 2022 ratio is 0.83, above 0.8, although its period average is below that threshold. A decade-wide category can therefore hide later changes. Our interpretation is that firms should compare both the level and the time pattern, then investigate local demand, payments and delivery. These historical model ratios can help frame questions about a destination; they cannot establish future sales or an effect of the RCEP agreement.

Source [4]: Zhang and Asraf bin Abdullah (2026), Table 19. Groups use 2013–2022 averages. RCEP: Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership. Bilateral exports are allocated proxies, not directly observed flows.